World Security Council head Alexander Pierce, portrayed by Robert Redford, is one of the only men to whom Nick Fury listens. But now, Captain America must choose between following his instincts and being a good soldier who obeys his superiors' orders.

"As guys who grew up on '70s thrillers, there is a great symmetry to getting somebody like Robert Redford for this film, especially because of the roots of this movie in *Three Days of the Condor*," Director Joe Russo explains. "From a cultural standpoint, it's fun—not to mention that he's one of the great actors of all time and the biggest icon that we have in the business."

Director Anthony Russo agrees. "Pierce is a very complicated character, and the great thing about having Robert Redford in that character is when Pierce says it, it's true, because Robert Redford says it. And that was very useful in terms of the storytelling, and the emotional and dramatic dynamics in the film."